elimination of a large number of senior officers from amongst the freedom fighters as a result of first and third coups has left him, however, with very few senior colleagues to back him up.

The Resistance Force

The Indian spies knew that only a handful of major forces were in control in Bangladesh. The first was the Mujib Bahini founded by Sheikh Mujib but it was slowly losing mass support. The philosophy and aims of Mujib —secularism, socialism, non-alignment and a close relationship with India—had lost their appeal. The R&AW, which had started operating in Dhaka on a very small level, said that there was some support for the Mujib Bahini in the student community, particularly in Dhaka and Chittagong, but their militant activities failed to reach a level that could cause any serious difficulties for the administration.

Kader Bahini, which had participated in the liberation of Bangladesh under Abdul Kader Siddique, was the most active militant group opposed to the interim government that was virtually led by Ziaur Rahman. The R&AW examined its strength in case its future operations in Bangladesh needed local support. However, this group's effective sphere of operations was confined to the Mymensingh region with some sporadic activity in Pabna and Bogra districts. The strength of the Kader

Bahini was also limited; it had just one thousand to three thousand armed guerrillas. A R&AW report said:

A general study of their operations gives the impression that as organised at present, they are not equipped or trained to effectively face the regular troops of the Bangladesh army but have a continuing nuisance value. Kader Sid-dique utility as a